

# Night of Long Knives

Mid of 1934 ⇒ he was beginning to see the SA ⇒ particularly its leader → Ernst Rohm ⇒ as a threat

Hitler ⇒ had actually asked Rohm ⇒ to lead the SA in 1930 ⇒ but by 1932 ⇒ there was growing tension between them.

SA was nearly 3 million strong.

Its members ⇒ fiercely loyal to Rohm ⇒ supported his call to tax elite groups ⇒ landowners, industrialists ⇒ to help the unemployed

- this was awkward ⇒ as Hitler had been put into power by these groups.

Another elite group ⇒ army commanders ⇒ were suspicious of Rohm

⇒ they thought SA was a disreputable force ⇒ and were unsettled by Rohm's talk of making SA into a second German Army

Weekend of 29th June 1934 ⇒ Squads of SS men ⇒ arrested Rohm and other leading figures in SA.

Hitler ⇒ accused Rohm of planning to murder and overthrow him.

Rohm and possible 400 others were murdered.

purge ⇒ known as Night of Long Knives

Although SA ⇒ not disbanded afterwards ⇒ it lost much of its prestige and influence

⇒ many of its members ⇒ absorbed into army and SS.

SA ⇒ not sole target of purge.

Hitler also targeted his old rivals.

Von Papen ⇒ placed under house arrest.

His plans to control Hitler ⇒ tattered ⇒ he resigned as vice chancellor.

Hitler offered him post of ambassador to Austria ⇒ accepted ⇒ decision that saved him his life.

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